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VOL. 1 · TOWN OF ST. GEORGE

How a Three-Vote Split Cost the NNP the Capital

The NDC did not ride a wave into the Town of St. George. The opposition divided its own vote, and the NNP's wounds were self-inflicted, opened nearly two years before polling day. Claudette Joseph won with 1,269 votes; Peter David and Troy Noel, between them, had 1,266.

BY GREG HOSTEN TOWN OF ST. GEORGE, GRENADA

TOWN OF ST. GEORGE, GRENADA—Going into the 5th November general election, political commentators cast Peter David as the likely kingmaker in the capital. Instead the veteran politician, contesting for the first time under the banner of his new Democratic People's Movement, polled 730 votes. Attorney General Claudette Joseph of the governing NDC took the Town of St. George with 1,269, while the NNP's candidate, Troy Noel, drew 536.

> **"This was a split-opposition loss, not a rejection of the NNP in town."**
> GREG HOSTEN

Taken together, the two opposition tallies reach 1,266, three votes short of the winner. Not every David voter would have backed an NNP candidate, and some of his support plainly crossed party lines. Yet the arithmetic captures the story of the night in the capital: this was a split-opposition loss, not a rejection of the NNP in town.

A SMALL SEAT, WHERE EVERY HOUSEHOLD CAN BE REACHED

The Town of St. George is among the smallest constituencies in the country. This year it had 4,242 registered voters, of whom 2,555 cast ballots, so roughly 1,300 votes wins the seat. At that scale a determined candidate can personally reach almost every household, and a divided party can lose the seat on a handful of streets.

A PARTY DIVIDED

The NNP's troubles began at its own convention. Mr. David was one of only two contenders for the party leadership in December 2024, and he withdrew hours before the vote on 15th December, alleging that the process had been rigged in favour of Emmalin Pierre. On 20th January 2025, little more than a month after the party elected its new executive, he resigned from the NNP.

What began as a lost leadership race became, in turn, the loss of a sitting member of Parliament, then of his base, and finally of the seat itself. The breach never healed: Mr. David went on to found the Democratic People's Movement and to lead it into the 2026 election.

A BRANCH THAT COLLAPSED

The damage reached the constituency machine within days. That same January, the NNP's General Secretary confirmed that several executive members of its Town of St. George constituency group had resigned, leaving the party without a functioning local organisation in the capital for most of the electoral cycle.

In a seat this small, the branch is the campaign. Without one, the NNP entered the 2026 election in the capital with no organisation to locate its voters, no canvass list and no one to run polling day.

A CANDIDATE TOO LATE

When the NNP finally named a flag-bearer for the capital, it chose Troy Noel, who comes originally from the Darbeau area of the constituency but now lives at Hope Vale, in St. George South East. A candidate living outside the seat, and named late in the cycle, had little time to build the kind of trust a capital constituency rewards.

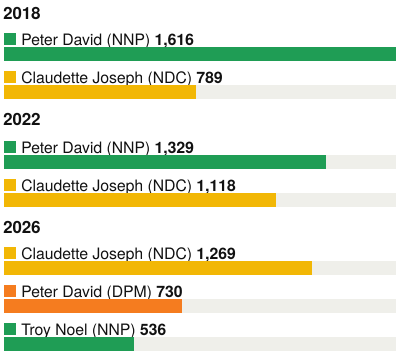
The outcome was the NNP's worst performance anywhere in the country. Its vote in the Town fell from 1,329 in 2022 to 536, a loss of 793, and its share of the two-party vote fell by 24.6 points, more than twice the national swing.

WHERE THE SPLIT HAPPENED

The polling-division returns trace the split street by street. The DPM finished ahead of the NNP in 10 of the 12 divisions; the NNP prevailed over the DPM only in the two

2018 VS 2022 VS 2026

Votes by candidate, in party colours



3 votes

NDC over the NNP and DPM combined

BY THE NUMBERS

3
Votes between the NDC and the NNP and DPM combined

14–1
NDC seats to the NNP's, nationally

1,189
Votes the DPM drew nationwide; its leader lost his seat

–793
Fall in the NNP vote in the Town since 2022

divisions at the St. George's Anglican Senior School.

Combined, the NNP and the DPM carried all five divisions at the National Stadium, the largest polling site, by 779 votes to the NDC's 609. The NDC, by contrast, won the seat in the older parts of town: at the Berean Christian Academy by 148 to 80 for the two opposition parties combined, at Norton's Hall on Church Street by 92 to 62, and at the Magistrate's Court by 52 to 33.

At Marryshow House the NDC won by 69 votes to 67 for the NNP and DPM together, and at the St. George's SDA School by 123 to 119. Those two divisions alone were decided by six votes.

PERSISTENCE PAYS FOR THE NDC

Ms. Joseph's victory came at the third attempt. In 2018 Mr. David, then the NNP's candidate, defeated her by 1,616 votes to 789; in 2022 he defeated her again, by 1,329 to 1,118. She nonetheless kept returning to the contest.

Her 2026 total of 1,269 was only 151 votes higher than in 2022. She did not need to grow much; she needed the opposition to divide, and it did. Her share of all registered voters barely moved, from 29.6 to 29.9 per cent, while the NNP's collapsed from 35.1 to 12.6 per cent.

WHY THE TIDE RAN SO STRONGLY

The split explains the capital, but it cannot explain a 14–1 national landslide in which the NDC took 61 per cent of the vote. Several forces beyond the NNP's internal troubles were at work.

The first was a record to run on. The analyst Derek Ramsamooj argued that Prime Minister Dickon Mitchell had shown he could use the office to deliver, and that voters were embracing new, young and dynamic leadership. The government, for its part, pointed to strong economic growth after Hurricane Beryl and to record citizenship-by-investment revenue.

The second was control of the battlefield. Mr. Mitchell called the election almost a year early, and the NDC had its campaign in place before the opposition was ready.

The third was the end of an era. This was the NNP's first campaign in decades without Dr. Keith Mitchell at its head, and the political scientist Peter Wickham observed that Dickon Mitchell has now defeated both the party's greatest figure and the party he left behind.

The fourth was a quieter electorate. Turnout fell to 63.3 per cent, from 70.2 per cent in 2022; in the Town it fell from 65.1 to 60.2 per cent.

THE LIMITS OF A THIRD PARTY

For Mr. David the obstacle was structural. Grenada's first-past-the-post system has long sustained a two-party contest, and anyone running outside the two dominant parties faces steep odds. The DPM drew 1,189 votes nationwide, and its leader lost his own seat.

His history also caught up with him. Mr. David first won the Town for the NDC in 2003 and held it until 2013. A falling-out with the Tillman Thomas-led NDC carried him to the NNP, which he represented in the seat in 2018 and 2022; a second falling-out, over the NNP's leadership process, led him to found the DPM. Personal popularity, however considerable, could not carry a brand-new party.

THREE HUNDRED AND SIXTY-SEVEN VOTERS

Against the NDC alone, the NNP would have needed 367 voters to switch sides, or 734 more supporters to turn out, to win the Town in 2026. The real arithmetic, however, is simpler: the NNP and the DPM together were three votes short. A reunited opposition in the capital therefore begins the next election within touching distance.

WHAT CAN BE DONE: A FOUR-YEAR PLAN FOR THE CAPITAL

The Town of St. George does not require a political earthquake. It requires the NNP to repair what it broke.

Year one, 2027: heal the split. Open talks with Mr. David's supporters and with the branch members who resigned, and create a clear route back for any who wish to return. Rebuild a working constituency executive, with officers who live in the seat.

Year two, 2028: select a candidate who lives in the constituency, chosen through the party's own process and endorsed by all its factions, and commit to that person for two elections. Open a permanent office in town.

Year three, 2029: appoint a captain for each of the 12 polling divisions. Hold the National Stadium divisions, where a united opposition already leads, and win back the older town divisions at Marryshow House and the SDA School, where the margin was a handful of votes.

Year four, 2030: campaign on a few local commitments, repeated everywhere, rather than a long manifesto, and serve the constituency year-round. Help that arrives only at campaign time reads as transactional; the candidate must be present when nothing is at stake.

THE LESSON FOR EVERY NNP SEAT

The Town of St. George was not lost to the NDC. It was lost to a division that began inside the NNP, at a convention nearly two years before polling day. Every subsequent volume in this series returns to the same theme: in 2026, the NNP's own decisions determined how badly each seat went.

In the capital, unity alone would have been worth the seat.

THE ARITHMETIC OF THE TOWN OF ST. GEORGE

Measure	2018	2022	2026
NNP votes	1,616	1,329	536
NDC votes	789	1,118	1,269
DPM votes (Peter David)			730
NNP and DPM combined			1,266
NNP share of two-party vote	67.2%	54.3%	29.7%
NNP two-party share nationally		48.0%	37.7%
Winning margin	NNP +827	NNP +211	NDC +733 (+3 over NNP and DPM)
Registered voters		3,781	4,242
Turnout		65.1%	60.2%
Polling divisions won by NNP and DPM combined			5 of 12

Two-party share excludes the DPM and minor candidates (2026: CHGCP 5). In 2018 and 2022 Peter David was the NNP candidate. 2026 figures are provisional results from the Parliamentary Elections Office, all 12 polling divisions verified.

WHAT IT MEANS FOR 2030/31

1. Heal the split first: unity alone was worth the seat in 2026.
2. Own the branch: keep a working constituency executive years before the writ.
3. Live in the seat, and be chosen early through the party's own process.
4. Win on your own brand, strong enough to hold against the national tide.
5. Three promises, not hundreds: a few local commitments, repeated everywhere.
6. Serve year-round: help that arrives only at campaign time reads as transactional.
7. Hold the National Stadium divisions, where a united opposition already leads.
8. Win back the old-town divisions decided by a handful of votes.

Sources: Parliamentary Elections Office live results, live.elections.gd (2026, provisional; polling divisions read 9 Nov 2026); NOW Grenada (NNP convention, Dec 2024; Peter David resignation, 21 Jan 2025; Town constituency group resignations, 22 Jan 2025; 2026 results); The New Today; CMC via CBC Barbados, Nation News and Jamaica Observer; Caribbean National Weekly; Grenada Chronicle; Rio Times; Searchlight (2018 results); Wikipedia (2022 results). Analytics computed by the author from the published counts. Analysis by Greg Hosten, Vol. 1 of a weekly constituency series. Written in the style of a newspaper report; not a publication of any news organisation.